

Impact High · Difficulty Hard · Misuse risk It fails when the four steps become polished blame: "observations" loaded with judgements

THE MOVE

Observation -> Feeling -> Need -> Request -> When X happened, I felt Y, because I need Z. Would you be willing to do A? -> "When the report went out without my name on it, I felt overlooked, because credit matters to me. Would you add it before..."

START HERE

Say one plain observation, one feeling, the need under it, and one doable request — four short sentences, no jargon, no naming the steps.

SAY THIS

Plain openers	<i>"Can I put something plainly?"</i>
Say what you saw, no...	<i>"When the meeting ran twenty minutes over?"</i>
Name the feeling and...	<i>"I felt overlooked, and I think it's because being counted matters to me."</i>
Make one clear, doable...	<i>"Would you be willing to give me a heads-up next time?"</i>
Soften, check, and balance...	<i>"Have I got that right, or am I missing something?"</i>
When it's heated	<i>"Can we both slow this down for a second?"</i>

AVOID

- Physical safety or an immediate emergency — act first, talk later
- When you would be weaponising vulnerability to get your way
- Manipulative or pressuring requests dressed up as needs

REMEMBER

Scaffolding, not the conversation.